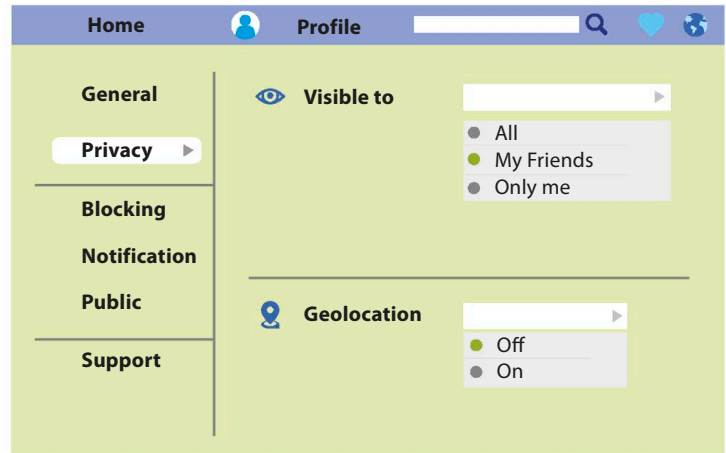


Social media

Although it is a positive way to connect with friends, social media can often be stressful for young people. This could be due to unrealistic pressures to look a certain way, or unkind comments from others. There's also the danger of private messages or pictures being circulated widely. Parents can help by making kids aware of these issues and discussing practical ways to avoid feelings of inadequacy. Boosting their confidence and making them aware of their right to say no can also help.

▷ Privacy settings

Social media privacy settings allow users to hide their posts so that strangers can't access them. Disabling location settings can stop people from identifying where a person is.

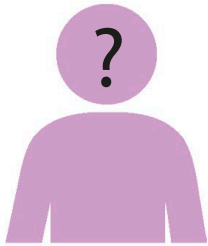


False identities

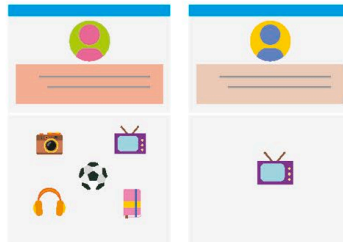
While chatting with new people on the internet can be a great way to make friends and connect with people with shared interests, it can also present some dangers. People don't have to use real photos of themselves, or their real name, or be telling the truth about anything they say. While this can be a way for users to explore their identities, it is unfortunately also possible for criminals to use it as a way to contact young people.

▽ Fake profiles

People who want to insult or antagonize others online – also known as “trolling” – often set up a new profile under a fake name so their activities are hard to trace back to them. As a result, it's usually relatively easy to spot these social media profiles.



A fake profile often doesn't include a photo or uses a very artificial-looking generic photo.



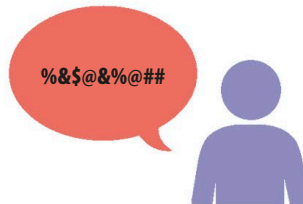
Fake profiles may not include much personal information, while real profiles list information like interests or job.



Having an extremely small number of friends or followers is another feature to be wary of.



Fake profiles sometimes use screen names made of a series of random letters and numbers.



A account that posts abusive content only is most likely a fake account.